

## Masking the Bristol

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Bristol and its ante-form are always fascinating themes. Even after Dr Milan Vuckcevic wrote an excellent and exhaustive article 'Beauty of Bristol' in Matplus pages twenty years ago I am still drawn to any interesting variant of the popular Bristol. Recently I came across 'Masking of Bristol' by Kabe Moen, Editor of the Problemist, with illustrative examples. The first example by the Indonesian master is an interesting mutate with set play. 1..Ke2 2.d3; 1...Ne2 2.Bc2: 1...Ke4 2.Bc2; 1...f2 2.Bc4. The beautiful double battery mate after 1...Ke2 is completely discarded by the clearance key **1.Rda1!** and now 1...Nc2 2.Qb1; 1...Ke2 2.Bc4. The Bristol clearance for the wQ takes place along the first rank which is masked by the bSg1.

Touw Hian Bwee  
4 prize, Die Schwalbe 1987



Mate in two moves

Henry D Bernard was known for his use of clearance moves in mutates is a perfect example. The relevant set play is 1...Nb- Qxd3. The rocket key move **1.Rb8!** gives up the extra guard on d3 to clear the way for the wQ to reach b7 after 1...Nb any.

Note that this is a pure Bristol clearance in the sense that the key

piece has no function after it makes its move.

Henry D.O.Bernard  
Source? 1916



Mate in two moves

The problem for solving below is an attempt by the author to show what seems to be an original masked clearance by the white queen and attains a triplet of black rook defences with dual avoidance.

Kabe Moen  
Original



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article; 'Master of three-movers'

**Key 1.Kc5!!** Spectacular, under two checks, placing Black in a zugzwang. 1...d3+ 2.Kd6! (not 2.Kb4?, and Black is blocked) 2...Nxc4+ 3.Qxc4#, 2...Nf7 3.Qxf7#, 2...Nd7 3.Kxd7#, 1...dxc3+ 2.Kb4! – retreat, but not 2. Kd6? cxd2!, and the king blocks the queen, 2...cxd2 3.Qxe5#.

Readers may send in their queries to  
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